

IN ALL THINGS OF NATURE THERE IS SOMETHING OF THE MARVELOUS

CLASSIFICATION OF LIVING THINGS

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Aristotle (*c.* 384–322 BCE)

BEFORE

***c.* 1500 BCE** Different properties of plants are recognized by ancient Egyptians.

AFTER

8th–9th centuries CE Islamic scholars of the Umayyad and Abbasid dynasties translate many of Aristotle's works into Arabic.

1551–58 Conrad Gessner's *History of Animals* classifies the animals of the world into five basic groups.

1686–1704 John Ray publishes his *History of Plants*, which lists more than 18,000 species.

1735 Carl Linnaeus devises a system of binomial names, the first consistent classification of organisms, according to which he names every species listed in his *Systema Naturae*.

From the beginning of recorded history, people have attempted to identify organisms according to their uses. Egyptian wall paintings from *c.* 1500 BCE